AERAPASS

# Which Payment Rail Should You Use?

SWIFT vs SEPA vs ACH vs Stablecoins
A decision framework for cross-border payments

Swipe to read →

# Not All Rails Are Equal

The rail you choose determines your settlement speed, cost, and availability.

Most businesses default to SWIFT for everything - even when faster, cheaper options exist.

# SWIFT

Reach: Global (200+ countries)
Settlement: Same day to 2 business days
Cost: 3-7% per transaction
Availability: Banking hours only

Best for: Large cross-border transfers where global reach matters more than speed

# SEPA

Reach: EU / EEA (36 countries)
Settlement: Near real-time to 1 business day
Cost: Low fixed fee per transfer
Currency: EUR only

Best for: Euro-denominated payments within Europe

# ACH

Reach: United States
Settlement: Same day or next business day
Cost: Low fixed fee per transaction
Currency: USD only

Best for: Domestic US payments - payroll, vendor payments, recurring billing

# Stablecoin Settlement

Reach: Global
Settlement: Minutes, not days
Cost: Below 1% (vs 3-7% SWIFT)
Availability: 24/7 including weekends

Best for: Speed-critical cross-border payments, weekend settlement, cost-sensitive corridors

# Side by Side

SWIFT SEPA ACH Stablecoins
Speed Days Hours Hours Minutes
Cost 3-7% Low Low Below 1%
Reach Global EU/EEA US Global
24/7 No No No Yes

# The Right Rail for Every Transaction

Modern financial infrastructure gives you the choice - not the constraint.

One platform, multiple rails, same compliance layer.

aerapass.io